

SEDAR 29: HMS Gulf of Mexico Blacktip Sharks

Research recommendations from the Standard Assessment Report

- Conduct age, growth and reproductive studies of blacktip sharks in the western Gulf of Mexico.
- Examine the stock structure of blacktip sharks in the Gulf of Mexico using genetic analyses, continued conventional tagging and advanced tagging technologies.
- Benchmark assessment to be undertaken focusing on treating blacktip sharks in the eastern and western Gulf of Mexico as separate stocks.
- A brief technical document should be produced to define “post release”, “at vessel mortality”, “status” and other terms for consistency and future discussions.
- Mexican colleagues must be involved in the next assessment to improve data inputs.
- Continue to work to achieve good species identification for weighouts/landings/reporting for commercial fisheries. Continue to have workshops for fishers/dealers to learn species identification. Workshops for recreational fishermen to work towards better species ID are also needed.
- Add a discards section to the logbooks for commercial fisheries.
- More research is necessary on post-release live discard mortality for both commercial and recreational fisheries